

You can communicate with a Service running in a different process using broadcast Intents or through the extras Bundle in the Intent used to start the Service. If you need a more tightly coupled connection you can make a Service available for binding across application boundaries using Android Interface Definition Language (AIDL). AIDL defines the Service's interface in terms of OS level primitives, allowing Android to transmit objects across process boundaries.

5.4 Prioritising Background Services

When calculating which applications and application components should be killed, Android assigns running Services the second-highest priority. Only active, foreground Activities are considered a higher priority in terms of system resources. In extreme cases, in which your Service is interacting directly with the user, it may be appropriate to lift its priority to the equivalent of a foreground Activity's. Do this by setting your Service to run in the foreground using the `startForeground` method.

Services running in the foreground may interact directly with the user (for example, by playing music). Because of this, the user should always be aware of a foreground Service. To ensure this, calls to `startForeground` must specify an ongoing Notification. This Notification will continue for at least as long as the Service is running in the foreground.

```
int NOTIFICATION_ID = 1;

Intent intent = new Intent(this, MyActivity.class);
PendingIntent pi = PendingIntent.getActivity(this, 1,
intent, 0));
Notification notification = new Notification(R.drawable.
icon,
    "Running in the Foreground", System.currentTimeMillis());
notification.setLatestEventInfo(this, "Title", "Text", pi);

notification.flags = notification.flags |
    Notification.FLAG_ONGOING_EVENT;
startForeground(NOTIFICATION_ID, notification);
```

This code uses `setLatestEventInfo` to update the Notification using the default status window layout. Later in this chapter, you'll learn how to specify a custom layout for your Notification. Using this technique, you can provide more details of your ongoing Service to users.